

1947, May 25.

The following is a faithful transcription of the carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX PRIARY: HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

May 25th Pentecost Sunday, 1947

Doctor J. P. Young 229 Roche Street Huntington, Indiana

My dear Doctor Young:

God bless you and yours. I hope you are well. Perhaps I ought rather to say I am trying to hope for your welfare, - spiritual of course and especially, as well as physically and socially: because after all in the sight of Heaven, the first is what supremely counts.

I have been wanting to write you Doctor these several months. In fact I started a couple of letters to you before Christmas, especially when I learned of your serious heart-attack and enrolled you in the Seraphic Mass Association. But first let me too, as a member of the community, thank you for your charitable favor to Rev. Father Guardian several weeks ago. I was doubly pleased to hear of it - for your own sake as well as for the needy poor. For it would seem in many cases that just such exercises of charity has meant the final salvation of many a soul otherwise most likely lost.

Now dear Doctor Young; I want to tell you in all sincerity and truth, that for close to a year you have been a problem on my mind, and I feel that I would not be a friend of yours or a grateful patient were I to let the present holy Easter Season pass without at least fraternally calling your attention to the very grave danger ahead of you, of completely losing the very little faith in Jesus Christ and His Church which, (un) fortunately at least, you seem to have left. But; "Why such an alarming conclusion?", you will ask. For indeed your outlook in my way of reckoning is grave.

First. Because, according to the greatest theologians, the first punishment on sin is the withdrawal of sanctifying grace - of God himself, therefore, - and the consequent weakening of the soul to fall again with less resistance into the same and other sins. For: "God will not remain in a soul subject (to) sin." But surely this must apply to the culpable neglect to foster and to practice that God-given faith that we have so gratuitously received and which has been so tenderly and conscientiously fostered in our souls, - God himself breathing it into our very immortal souls with loving parents and tutors so providentially solicitous.